

Algorithms

Lecture #45

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Reductions

Reductions

- The 3-color (3Col) problem will play the role of A, which we strongly suspect to not be solvable in polynomial time.
- For our problem B, consider the following problem:

Reductions

Reductions

- Given a graph $G = (V, E)$, we say that a subset of vertices $V' \subseteq V$ forms a clique if for every pair of vertices $u, v \in V'$, the edge $(u, v) \in E$
- That is, the subgraph induced by V' is a complete graph.

Clique Cover

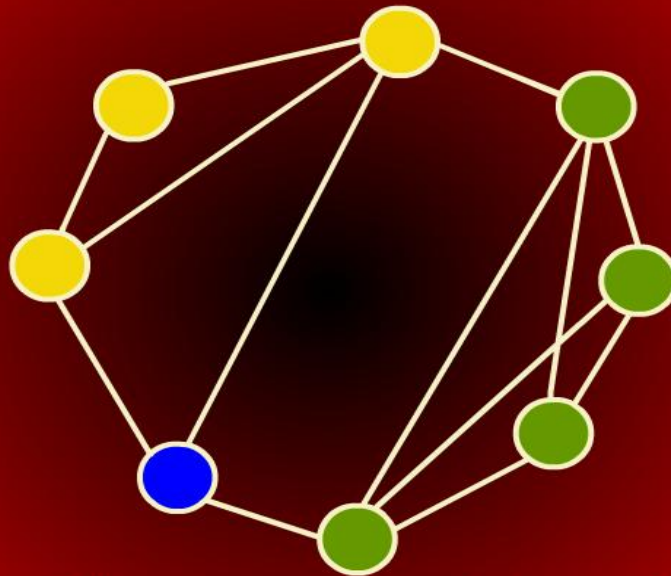
Clique Cover

Clique Cover: (CCov)

- Given a graph G and an integer k , can we find k subsets of vertices $V_1, V_2, \dots, V_k$, such that $\cup_i V_i = V$, and that each V_i is a clique of G .

Clique Cover

Clique Cover



Clique cover (size=3)

Clique Cover

Clique Cover

- The clique cover problem arises in applications of clustering.
- We put an edge between two nodes if they are similar enough to be clustered in the same group.
- We want to know whether it is possible to cluster all the vertices into k groups.

Reductions

Reductions

- Suppose that you want to solve the CCov problem.
- But after a while of fruitless effort, you still cannot find a polynomial time algorithm for the CCov problem..
- How can you prove that CCov is likely to not have a polynomial time solution?

Reductions

Reductions

- You know that 3Col is NP-complete and hence, experts believe that $3\text{Col} \notin P$.
- You feel that there is some connection between the CCov problem and the 3Col problem.
- Thus, you want to show that $(3\text{Col} \notin P) \Rightarrow (\text{CCov} \notin P)$

Reductions

Reductions

- Both problems involve partitioning the vertices into groups.
- In the clique cover problem, for two vertices to be in the same group, they must be adjacent to each other.
- In the 3-coloring problem, for two vertices to be in the same color group, they must not be adjacent.

Reductions

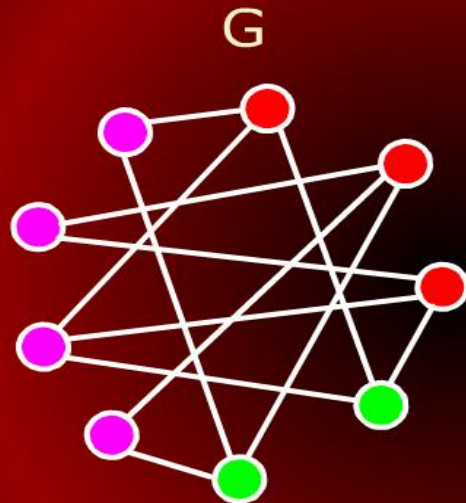
Reductions

two vertices to be in the same group, they must be adjacent to each other.

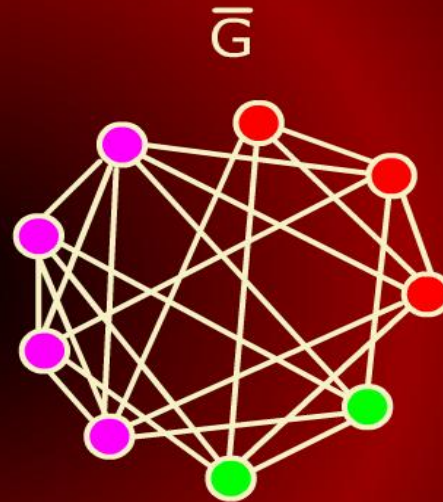
- In the 3-coloring problem, for two vertices to be in the same color group, they must not be adjacent.
- In some sense, the problems are almost the same but the adjacency requirements are exactly reversed.

3-Colorability $\Leftrightarrow$ Clique Cover

3-Colorability $\Leftrightarrow$ Clique Cover



3-Colorable

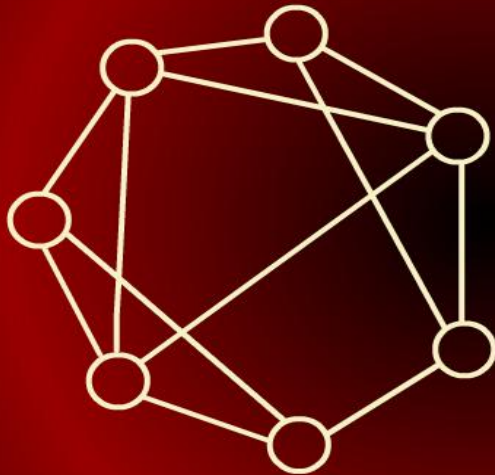


Coverable by 3
cliques

3-Colorability $\Leftrightarrow$ Clique Cover

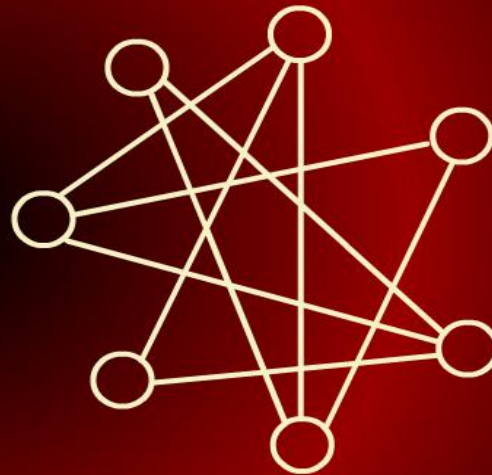
3-Colorability $\Leftrightarrow$ Clique Cover

H



Not 3-colorable

$\bar{H}$



Not coverable

Polynomial Time Reduction

Polynomial Time Reduction

Definition:

- We say that a decision problem L_1 is polynomial-time reducible to decision problem L_2 (written $L_1 \leq_p L_2$) if there is polynomial time computable function f such that for all x , $x \in L_1$ if and only if $f(x) \in L_2$.

Polynomial Time Reduction

Polynomial Time Reduction

- In the previous example we showed that
$$3\text{Col} \leq_P \text{CCov}$$
- In particular, we have
$$f(G) = (\overline{G}, 3).$$
- It is easy to complement a graph in $O(n^2)$ (i.e., polynomial time).
- For example, flip the 0's and 1's in the adjacency matrix.

Polynomial Time Reduction

Polynomial Time Reduction

- The way this is used in NP-completeness is that we have strong evidence that L_1 is not solvable in polynomial time.
- Hence, the reduction is effectively equivalent to saying that “since L_1 is not likely to be solvable in polynomial time, then L_2 is also not likely to be solvable in polynomial time.

NP-Completeness

NP-Completeness

Definition:

A decision problem L is NP-Hard if
 $L' \leq_P L$ for all $L' \in \text{NP}$.

Definition:

L is NP-complete if

1. $L \in \text{NP}$ and
2. $L' \leq_P L$ for some known
NP-complete problem L' .

NP-Completeness

NP-Completeness

- The set of NP-complete problems is all problems in the complexity class NP for which it is known that if any one is solvable in polynomial time, then they all are.
- Conversely, if any one is not solvable in polynomial time, then none are.

Recap

Recap

Let us recap

P: is the set of decision problems that are solvable in polynomial time.

NP: is the set of decision problems that can be verified in polynomial time.

Polynomial reduction: $L_1 \leq_P L_2$ means that there is a polynomial time computable function f such that $x \in L_1$ if and only if $f(x) \in L_2$.

Recap

Recap

NP-Hard: L is NP-hard if for all $L' \in \text{NP}$, $L' \leq_p L$. Thus if we could solve L in polynomial time, we could solve all NP problems in polynomial time.

NP-Complete: L is NP-complete if

1. $L \in \text{NP}$ and
2. L is NP-hard.

Recap

Recap

- The importance of NP-complete problems should now be clear.
- If any NP-complete problem is solvable in polynomial time, then every NP-complete problem is also solvable in polynomial time.
- Conversely, if we can prove that any NP-complete problem cannot be

Recap

Recap

- If any NP-complete problem is solvable in polynomial time, then every NP-complete problem is also solvable in polynomial time.
- Conversely, if we can prove that any NP-complete problem cannot be solved in polynomial time, then every NP-complete problem cannot be solvable in polynomial time.

cook's Theorem

Cook's Theorem

- We need to have at least one NP-complete problem to start the ball rolling.
- Stephen Cook showed that such a problem existed.
- He proved that the **boolean satisfiability problem** is NP-complete.

Boolean Satisfiability Problem

Boolean Satisfiability Problem

- A boolean formula is a logical formulation which consists of **variables** x_i .
- These variables appear in a logical expression using **logical operations**
 1. negation of x : $\bar{x}$
 2. boolean or: $(x \vee y)$
 3. boolean and: $(x \wedge y)$

Boolean Satisfiability Problem

Boolean Satisfiability Problem

SAT:

Given a boolean formula, is there a way to assign truth values (0/1, true/false) to the variables of the formula so that the formula evaluates to true?

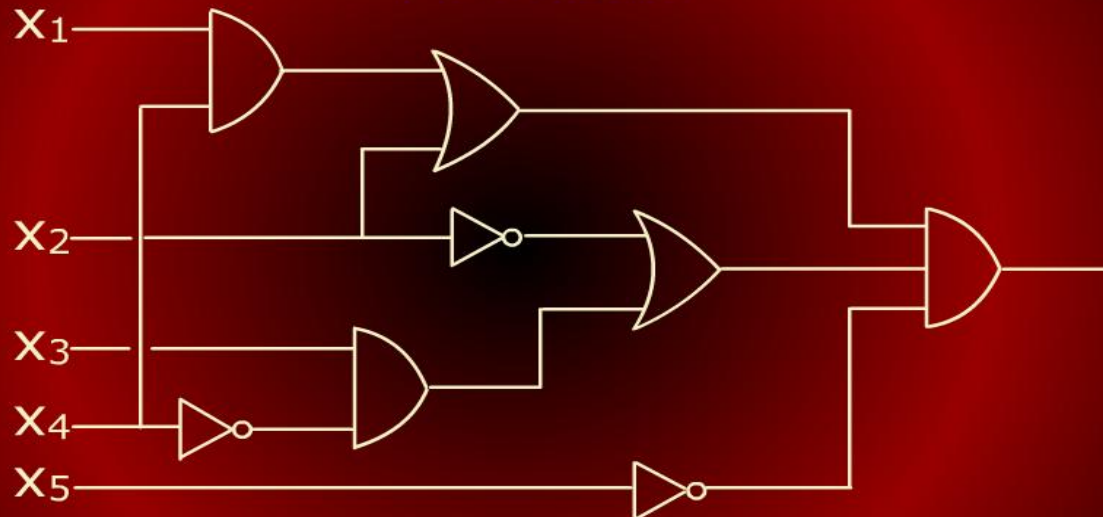
Boolean Satisfiability Problem

Boolean Satisfiability Problem

- For example
 $(x_1 \wedge (x_2 \vee \bar{x}_3)) \wedge ((\bar{x}_2 \wedge \bar{x}_3) \vee \bar{x}_1)$
is satisfiable, by the assignment
 $x_1 = 1, x_2 = 0$ and $x_3 = 0$.
- On the other hand,
 $(\bar{x}_1 \vee (x_2 \wedge x_3)) \wedge (x_1 \vee (\bar{x}_2 \wedge \bar{x}_3)) \wedge$
 $(x_2 \vee x_3) \wedge (\bar{x}_2 \vee \bar{x}_3)$
is not satisfiable.

Boolean Satisfiability Problem

Boolean Satisfiability Problem



$$((X_1 \wedge X_4) \vee X_2) \wedge ((X_3 \wedge \bar{X}_4) \vee \bar{X}_2) \wedge \bar{X}_5$$

cook's Theorem

Cook's Theorem

Cook's Theorem: SAT is NP-complete

- We will not prove the theorem; it is quite complicated.
- In fact, it turns out that a even more restricted version of the satisfiability problem is NP-complete.
- A **literal** is a variable x or its negation $\bar{x}$.

3-Conjunctive Normal Form

3-Conjunctive Normal Form

- A boolean formula is in **3-Conjunctive Normal Form (3-CNF)** if it is the boolean-and of clauses where each clause is the boolean-or of exactly three literals.
- For example,
$$(x_1 \vee x_2 \vee \overline{x}_3) \wedge (\overline{x}_1 \vee x_3 \vee x_4) \wedge (x_2 \vee \overline{x}_3 \vee \overline{x}_4)$$
 is in 3-CNF form

3-Conjunctive Normal Form

3-Conjunctive Normal Form

- 3SAT is the problem of determining whether a formula is 3-CNF is satisfiable.
- 3SAT is NP-complete.
- We can use this fact to prove that other problems are NP-complete.
- We will do this with the **independent set problem**.

Independent Set Problem

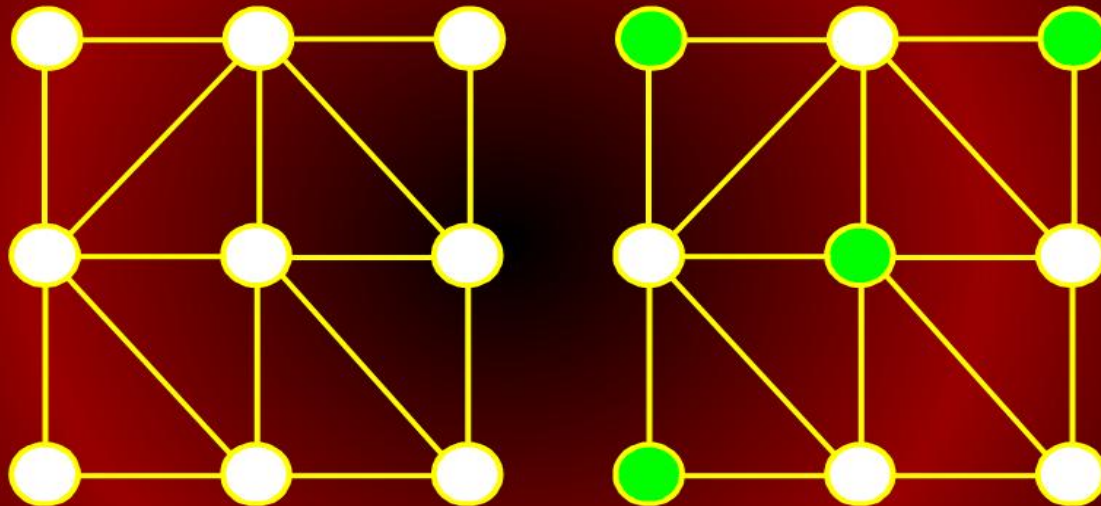
Independent Set Problem

Independent Set Problem:

Given an undirected graph $G = (V, E)$ and an integer k , does G contain a subset V' of k vertices such that no two vertices in V' are adjacent to each other.

Edit Distance

Edit Distance



Independent set of size 4

Independent Set Problem

Independent Set Problem

- The independent set problem arises when there is some sort of selection problem where there are mutual restrictions pairs that cannot both be selected.
- For example, a company dinner where an employee and his/her immediate supervisor cannot both be invited.

Independent Set Problem

Independent Set Problem

Claim: IS is NP-complete
The proof involves two parts.

Independent Set Problem

Independent Set Problem

First: we need to show that $IS \in NP$.

- The certificate consists of k vertices of V' .
- We simply verify that for each pair of vertices $u, v \in V'$, there is no edge between them.
- Clearly, this can be done in polynomial time, by an inspection of the adjacency matrix.

Independent Set Problem

Independent Set Problem

Second: we need to establish that IS is NP-hard

- This can be done by showing that some known NP-complete (3SAT) is polynomial-time reducible to IS.
- That is, $3SAT \leq_P IS$.

Independent Set Problem

Independent Set Problem

Requirements:

3SAT: Each clause must contain at least one true valued literal.

IS: V' must contain at least k vertices.

Independent Set Problem

Independent Set Problem

Restrictions:

3SAT: If x_i is assigned true, then $\bar{x}_i$ must be false and vice versa.

IS: If u is selected to be in V' and v is a neighbor of u then v cannot be in V' .

3SAT

3SAT $\leq_P$ IS

3SAT-TO-IS(F:boolean formula in 3-CNF)

1 $k \leftarrow$ number of clauses in F

2 **for** (each clause C in F)

3 **do** create a clause cluster of

4 3 vertices from literals of C

5 **for**(each clause cluster (x_1, x_2, x_3))

6 **do** create an edge (x_i, x_j) between

7 all pairs of vertices in the cluster

8 **for** (each vertex x_i)

3SAT

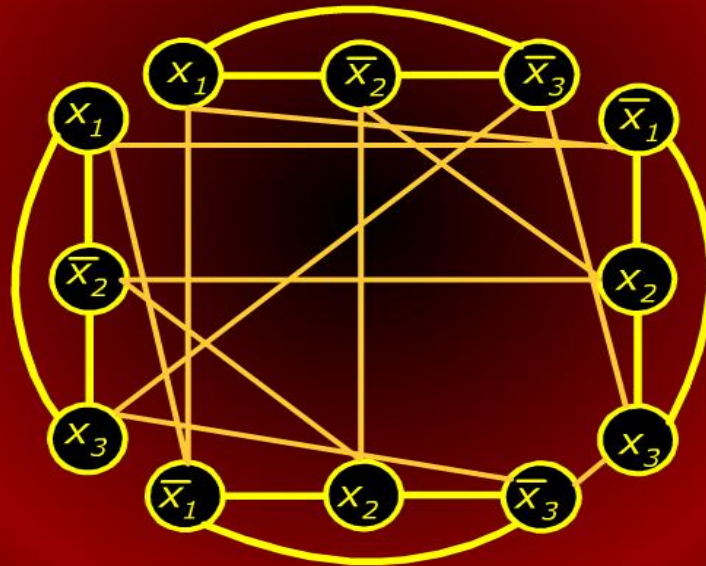
3SAT $\leq_P$ IS

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6 do create an edge  $(x_i, x_j)$  between
7   all pairs of vertices in the cluster
8 for ( each vertex  $x_i$  )
9 do create an edge between  $x_i$  and
10  all its complement vertices  $\bar{x}_i$ 
11 return  $(G, k)$  output is graph  $G$  and
    integer  $k$ 
```


3SAT

3SAT $\leq_P$ IS

$$(x_1 \vee \bar{x}_2 \vee \bar{x}_3) \wedge (\bar{x}_1 \vee x_2 \vee x_3) \wedge (\bar{x}_1 \vee x_2 \vee \bar{x}_3) \wedge (x_1 \vee \bar{x}_2 \vee x_3)$$



3SAT

3SAT $\leq_P$ IS

$$(x_1 \vee \overline{x_2} \vee \overline{x_3}) \wedge (\overline{x_1} \vee x_2 \vee x_3) \wedge (\overline{x_1} \vee x_2 \vee \overline{x_3}) \\ \wedge (x_1 \vee \overline{x_2} \vee x_3)$$

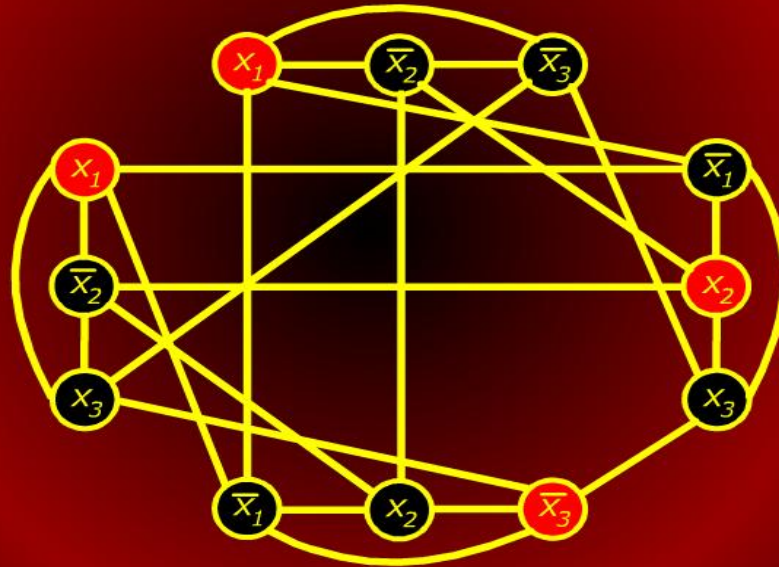
The boolean formula is satisfied by the assignment $x_1 = 1, x_2 = 1, x_3 = 0$

By selecting vertices corresponding to true literals in each clause, we get an independent set of size $k = 4$.

3SAT

3SAT $\leq_P$ IS

$x_1 = 1, x_2 = 1$ and $x_3 = 0$.



3SAT

$3SAT \leq_P IS$

- The transformation clearly runs in polynomial time.
- Also observe that the the reduction had no knowledge of the solution to either problem.
- Computing the solution to either will require exponential time.
- Instead, the reduction simple translated the input from one problem into an equivalent input to the other problem.

Coping with NP-Completeness

Coping with NP-Completeness

Use brute-force search: Even on the fastest parallel computers this approach is viable only for the smallest instance of these problems.

Heuristics: A heuristic is a strategy for producing a valid solution but there are no guarantees how close it to optimal. This is worthwhile if all else fails.

Graph Coloring

Boolean Satisfiability problem